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Chicano COINTELPRO

FEDERAL POLICE PLOT TO DESTROY MEXICAN-AMERICAN UNITY



The Chicano movement here in the U.S. was a target of the FBI's notorious COINTELPRO and Operation CHAOS, a CIA plan to harass leading Chicano activists and organizations.

(New York, N.Y.) - Strong evidence points to the existence of a COINTELPRO (Counter-intelligence Program)-type conspiracy by federal, state and local police agencies to "destroy, disrupt and discredit" the Chicano movement in the U.S., the *Militant* reports.

While specific government documents detailing the all-out government war against Chicano activists and organizations have yet to be unearthed, there is concrete proof that from the very beginning of the Chicano struggles in the 1960's, the U.S. power structure — acting much as it has in the continuing FBI COINTELPRO plot against the Black Panther Party — has sought to smash the Chicano movement:

- Materials released under the Freedom of Information Act to Jose Angel Gutierrez, a founding leader of the Texas Raza Unida Party, a Chicano political party, have revealed an elaborate plan — dubbed "operation CHAOS: 'Chicano Power Movement'" — by the Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) to harass every leading Chicano activist and organization in the *movimiento*.

- As early as 1964, the Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) was maintaining files on and actively seeking to sabotage Alianza, an organization in northern New Mexico seeking to reclaim lands that had belonged to Mexican-Americans before the U.S. conquest of the Southwest.

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